



**DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE**  
**STUDENT ACADEMIC AFFAIRS & ACADEMY REGISTRAR**  
**UNITED STATES AIR FORCE ACADEMY**

22 Dec 25

**MEMORANDUM FOR MAJOR UNIT SCHEDULING COORDINATORS**

**FROM:** HQ USAFA/DFVR

**SUBJECT:** Fall 2026 Preferred Course Offering Guidance

1. The following Preferred Course Offering (PCO) requirements must be followed. DFVR and the Vice Dean for Academics (DFW) are the waiver authority for exceptions. There are 6 periods per day available for scheduling academic courses; departments must utilize all 12 offering times (M1 – T6). Underutilized early morning and late afternoon periods contribute to cadet scheduling conflicts. Ensure course directors provide you with all of their requests/restrictions and coordinate across departments if cadet enrollments are shared (double majors, etc.) for small courses. Department Scheduling Coordinators will document their PCO in a DFVRR-provided format and return to DFVRR.

**2. Section Offerings:**

- A course with 10 or more sections must have at least six offering times evenly distributed between M- and T-day (with more sections in the mornings), and these offering times must include M1 and T1. Of offered sections, M1, M2, T1, and T2 should have as many or more sections than other offering times. At least 25% of sections must be offered in the afternoon 5<sup>th</sup> or 6<sup>th</sup> periods on M- or T-day.
- Multiple section offerings of a single course should be equally distributed over both M- and T-days and throughout the day unless all sections are taught by a single instructor.
- A single-period academic course with an enrollment of 250 or more will be offered at all available periods (M1 - T6); if multiple sections are required for available periods, multiple-section periods in the morning should outnumber multiple-section periods in the afternoon. Of the 12 offering times, both M1 and T1 should have as many or more sections than other offering times.
- Double-period courses must begin 1<sup>st</sup>, 3<sup>rd</sup>, or 5<sup>th</sup> periods. Double-period courses with an enrollment of 250 or more will be offered across all available times (i.e., M1/2, M3/4, M5/6, T1/2, T3/4, and T5/6). Of the 6 offering times, both M1/2 and T1/2 should have as many or more sections than other offering times.
- Courses meeting every day (i.e., language courses) must be scheduled during periods M1, M2, M3, M4, M5, or M6. Afternoons and mornings must be utilized if 4 or more sections are offered.
- Independent Study courses (499s) are unscheduled. The period should be input with Room: NONE and scheduling code NSH. T-Day Dean's Time (1230 - 1323) is available as a dedicated meeting time with these cadets.
- All Special Topics Courses (495s) are single-period, 3.0 sem hr courses.
- Offered seats in planned sections will exceed enrollment by ~10% (e.g., for 200 registered cadets, available seats will be ~220) to allow for scheduling flexibility and schedule conflict resolution.
- Limiting a course to one offering time contributes to scheduling conflicts and should be avoided unless course enrollment will not allow multiple sections.

- Courses with one offering must not be offered during 1st, 5th, or 6th periods unless the department is confident that there are no ICs in need of the course to meet graduation requirements with a practice excusal during the offering. ICs have a high rate of excusal during 1st, 5th, and 6th, and single course offerings are expected to cause significant conflicts.
- For courses with only two sections, back-to-back section offerings must be avoided during a double-period block (e.g., M1 and M2) as that contributes to scheduling conflicts. You may offer back-to-back offerings if the sections span two double-period blocks (e.g., M2 and M3).

### 3. Course Enrollment:

- If a course's enrollment is 10 or less, the department may cancel the course. If cancelling the course, the Scheduling Coordinator will notify DFVRR 1) when the PCO information is updated in COMPASS, if appropriate, and 2) with an updated PCO spreadsheet. Once a course is canceled, it may not be reopened for the affected semester. The department cancelling the course will notify the impacted cadets and academic advisors. If the course's enrollment is greater than 10, the course requires DFW approval to be canceled.
- If a course's enrollment is fewer than six, DFVRR will cancel the course unless a waiver has been approved by DFW. Independent study courses (499, 499A, 499B, 499C) do not fall under this requirement for minimum enrollment.

### 4. Special Requests:

- If a mini-lectinar or oversize classroom is requested, please specify why this is needed (e.g., sections being combined, section size exceeds general purpose classroom capacity, or other circumstances). The default is to schedule sections in teaching spaces without unnecessary excess seats.
- Upon departmental request, DFVRR will attempt to schedule single contact-hour courses with only two sections on the same day. DFVRR will not consider multiple contact-hour courses and courses with three or more sections for this type of scheduling.
- Once cadet schedules are published in COMPASS and before transition day(s) at the start of the semester, departments can request DFVRR balance section sizes (resectioning) to address significant ( $\geq 5$  student differences between sections) imbalances in section enrollments. DFVRR will review requests for resectioning and make changes that do not negatively influence other courses/section enrollments. The requesting department is responsible for notifying impacted cadets that their class schedules have changed and will not be returned to their previous configuration.
- Capping future term course enrollments in COMPASS (Course Demand Control Table). Capping core course enrollments requires DFW approval. Capping non-core courses is at the discretion of the offering department to include coordination with other impacted departments.

Respectfully,

TAYLOR.HAROLD  
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HAL A. TAYLOR, JR., PhD, DAFC  
Associate Dean, Student Academic Affairs  
& Academy Registrar